

er category to fit them into, they go into miscellaneous.

Obviously, when a family making \$24,000-a-year gross income tries to pay \$150-250 a month private school expenses, it won't fit into a 5 percent budget for miscellaneous. In fact, it will be closer to 15 percent. This means there must be sacrifices made in other areas to maintain children in Christian schools.

It is not the responsibility of creditors to educate our children. I counsel couples not to borrow to maintain this expense. If it is God's will that the children attend a Christian school, He *will* provide, and *not* through loans either. As Psalms 37:25 says, "I have been young, and now I am old; yet I have not seen the righteous forsaken, or his descendants begging bread." I recall a counseling session I had with a woman who had been divorced by her husband. Her lifestyle changed from abundance to meager existence almost overnight. She had come for counseling at the request of her pastor and was trying to adjust from an income of \$10,000 a month to about \$1,500.

One of the first areas I noticed was an expense for a Christian school of \$500 a month. When I asked about it, she was instantly defensive, and understandably so. Her children had suffered greatly by their father leaving and remarrying the day after the divorce was final.

I also knew that there was no way a \$500 school expense would fit into a \$1,500 gross monthly income. Her response to my question was, "I'll do without food rather than take my kids out of Christian school." A noble sentiment, but highly unlikely, I knew. So I offered an alternative suggestion. Why not lay this burden at God's feet and let Him decide if they should stay in the school. If He provided the means within her budget, she would know it was God's plan. "But," I told her, "you can't hedge and say, 'I'll do it IF God provides, but I'll also do it if He doesn't.' " She also agreed to approach the school principal and let him know her financial situation.

The principal agreed to work with this woman and was in the process of appealing to the school's loan committee on her